



Slovenian / University

What Actually Ran

Come and see



An invitation

Somewhere near you, a community centre has just printed its term catalogue. A full page of evening classes: the beginners' language table, the Tuesday repair session, the choir that meets when the hall is free. Some of them will run. Several will not — not because anyone withdrew the offer, but because the enrolments came in under the line, the tutor took other work, and the room went to a booking that had already firmed up. The catalogue stays on the noticeboard either way, and next term it is reprinted with much the same page.

Slop University works in that gap for a living. Our researchers study the join between what an organisation puts on the record and what its week actually delivers: the offer and the take-up, the notice and the room, the rating on the carton and the night the power went out. It is patient, unglamorous work, and it is the work that tells a community whether its catalogue is a plan or a wish.



That capability exists because people choose to underwrite it. Partners and supporters make it possible for the University to keep instruments in the field long enough to see what happens after the enrolments close — and to publish what they find, whichever way it falls.

At a glance

A short account of how the University works, and where a partner's support lands.



Where the work happens

Halls, shop floors, kerbsides, and kitchens. Our researchers take the institution's instruments to the settings its records describe, and stay long enough to watch both.



Instruments before opinions

Every claim the University makes about a system it studies is anchored to something counted, and the counting method is published alongside the count.



Open on the record

Research produced under the University's name is published open access and carries a persistent identifier minted by the Office of Research Outputs.



Support that stays with it

Partnership funds the long middle of a study — the weeks between an interesting question and a finding anyone can act on.

What we do

Three strands of work, all of them fastened to the same small distance: between what is advertised and what turns out to be so.

The offer and the take-up

The School of Continuous Improvement studies measurement systems that improve the things they measure — and the ones that quietly stop. Its programme on advertised offers follows a listing from the day it is published to the night it either

runs or doesn't: the class with a viable enrolment and the class held open past its own cut-off, the session that filled and the session that was folded into another room without the catalogue ever being reissued. The Adaptive Metrics Lab convenes the instrument work; the Master of Applied Measurement teaches it.



The finding that keeps recurring is not that organisations mislead. It is that the record of an offer is durable and cheap to reprint, while the account of what happened is fragile and expensive to keep — so the catalogue outlives the term, and the term goes unwritten.

“A catalogue is an intention that has been typeset. Our work is simply to stand in the room afterwards and record what the intention came to, which turns out to be the part almost nobody is resourced to do.”

— Dr Torun Ezeigwe, Senior Lecturer and Director, Master of Applied Measurement, School of Continuous Improvement

What the record keeps

The School of Emergent Priorities studies how priorities are sensed, sequenced, and sustained — and what survives the handover when the person who held them moves on. Its researchers read registers, rosters, and dashboards as artefacts in their own right: documents that were written to describe a room and then, over a few review cycles, came to stand in for it. The Horizon Register anchors the School's rolling

account of what is on approach; the Trajectory Analytics Group convenes the comparative work.



The School's interest is in the moment the substitution happens — when a counter, a receipt, or a tally stops being evidence about a thing and becomes the thing an organisation manages instead. It is a small hinge, and a great deal turns on it.

“Every record is a promise about the future — that someone will come back and read it against what occurred. What our work keeps finding is how rarely anyone is scheduled to.”

— Dr Iben Chikere, Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities

Instruments you can borrow

Much of what the University builds is designed to leave it. The Indicator Commons holds the shared indicator library; the Evaluation of Evaluation program reviews the measures already in circulation before another is added to them. A community organisation, a council, or a small provider that wants to know whether its own offer is landing can generally be met with an instrument that already exists, adapted by people who know its failure modes.



That transfer is deliberate. The University measures a great deal, but the capability it most wants to leave behind is the habit of going back to look — and the confidence that a measure which does not flatter the organisation holding it is still worth keeping.

Published this year

Three studies from the University's recent record, each resolvable in full through the research repository.

- **Rated for Three Days, Delivered for One** — what a home battery's advertised backup duration turns out to mean once the power is genuinely out, across instrumented households and real blackouts. doi:10.5555/slop.fw3hoa
- **The Promise That Never Changed** — a decade of a retail price-match guarantee whose headline sentence stayed put while the fine print beneath it grew. doi:10.5555/slop.qkclqm
- **Too Cold to Count** — public park barbecues found cold at unannounced inspection, and the usage counter that ranks them for renewal on a tick it only records when the plate heats. doi:10.5555/slop.v9ye2i

Every output the University publishes is available the same way, under an open licence, with the method described closely enough to be argued with.

Our people

Dr Torun Ezeigwe, Senior Lecturer and Director of the Master of Applied Measurement in the School of Continuous Improvement, follows a measurement instrument from its validation study into everyday use, tracking what a rubric comes to mean once the setting around it has moved on.

Dr Iben Chikere, Lecturer in the School of Emergent Priorities, studies what a handover document keeps of a role once its occupant has gone — the priorities restated for a successor, and the ones that quietly leave the page.

Your next step

If your organisation prints an offer — a term catalogue, a service schedule, a program of works — there is a version of this research that belongs to you, and we would like to do it with you rather than about you. Partners shape the questions, sit with the instruments while they are in the field, and see the findings before anyone else does, including the findings that are inconvenient.

Support for the University's research is what keeps the long middle of a study funded: the weeks after the enrolments close, when the interesting part is happening and nobody is watching. Come and see what we are working on, and what it would take to work on yours. The full record is at slop.university.



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